DAY 1 · REFERENCE

Nielsen Heuristics Audit Sheet

#	HEURISTIC	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
1	Visibility of system status	Does the user always know what's happening? Loading, progress, location.
2	Match between system & real world	Language, concepts, and flow feel familiar — not internal jargon.
3	User control & freedom	Can users undo, go back, or exit without getting trapped?
4	Consistency & standards	Same actions, labels, and patterns behave the same everywhere.
5	Error prevention	Does the design stop mistakes before they happen?
6	Recognition over recall	Options visible — user shouldn't have to remember hidden rules.
7	Flexibility & efficiency	Shortcuts for experts without blocking beginners.
8	Aesthetic & minimalist design	Every element earns its place. No noise.
9	Help users recover from errors	Clear error messages in plain language + a fix path.
10	Help & documentation	Contextual help when needed — not a manual dump.

Severity scale: 0 = cosmetic · 1 = minor · 2 = major · 3 = catastrophic (blocks task completion).

DAY 1 · WORKSHEET

Heuristic Audit Log

ISSUE FOUND	HEURISTIC #	SEVERITY (0–3)	RECOMMENDATION

Audit a daily app in 20 minutes. Log at least 3 issues with actionable recommendations.

DAY 1 · FRAMEWORK

Pain Point Prioritisation Matrix

- **High frequency + High severity** → Fix first. These block users repeatedly.
- **High frequency + Low severity** → Schedule. Annoying at scale.
- **Low frequency + High severity** → Watch. Rare but damaging when they occur.
- **Low frequency + Low severity** → Backlog. Nice to fix, not urgent.
- Plot today's affinity-map clusters on this matrix before moving to Day 2 research.

Pain point 1

Frequency: H / L · Severity: H / L · Action:

Pain point 2

Frequency: H / L · Severity: H / L · Action:

DAY 1 · GUIDE

Affinity Mapping Rules

- One idea per sticky. If it needs 'and', split it.
- Cluster by meaning, not by who said it or which screen it came from.
- Name clusters as insights, not features ('Users lose trust at payment' not 'Add progress bar').
- Aim for 5–8 clusters from 30–40 stickies. Merge small clusters; split oversized ones.
- Dot-vote: each person gets 3 votes on the clusters that matter most for the cohort challenge.

Use consistent colour coding: blue = observation, gold = insight, red = risk/gap.

DAY 1 · TEMPLATE

Cohort Challenge Brief

Problem context

What service/product are we improving? Why now?

Primary users

Who uses this? Role, context, constraints.

Top 3 pain points

From today's affinity map + prioritisation.

Success criteria

What does 'better' look like in measurable terms?

DAY 1 · CHECKPOINT

Responsible Design Flags

FLAG TYPE	WHAT WE NOTICED TODAY	REVISIT ON DAY 4?
Accessibility / inclusion gap		☐ Yes
AI / data risk		☐ Yes
Privacy concern		☐ Yes
Governance / policy gap		☐ Yes

Flag now, fix with intent on Day 4. Inclusion gaps are not 'nice to have' — they're design requirements.